

far as product satisfaction was concerned. Sony scraped the bottom of the barrel, but it scored the highest percentile points, with 94 per cent of respondents saying that they will buy a Sony product again. Apart from mind-

share the company also earned top marks in the Reliability Index beating out Samsung and Philips by a decent margin (the latter two had a close fight, with Samsung edging out Philips).

Samsung was criticised for its low-quality solutions by more than one

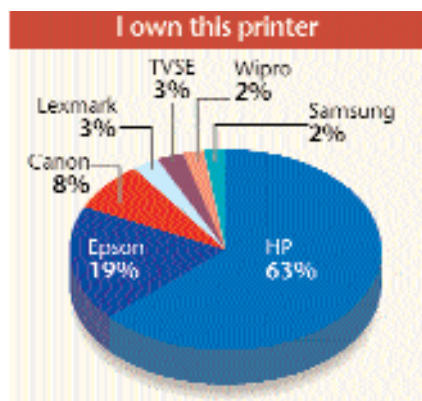
reader saying, "audio output quality not so good" and "the product is not up to the claim of the manufacturer, the service is absolutely nil." Suneel Mohan, a Yepp player user, claimed that "Yepp jumps audio tracks sometimes... when I asked the service station personnel they said that it's a common problem and that a replacement would take at least three months."

MOST RELIABLE MP3 PLAYER: Sony RUNNER-UP: Samsung
MOST SATISFACTORY SERVICE: Philips RUNNER-UP: Samsung

Printers

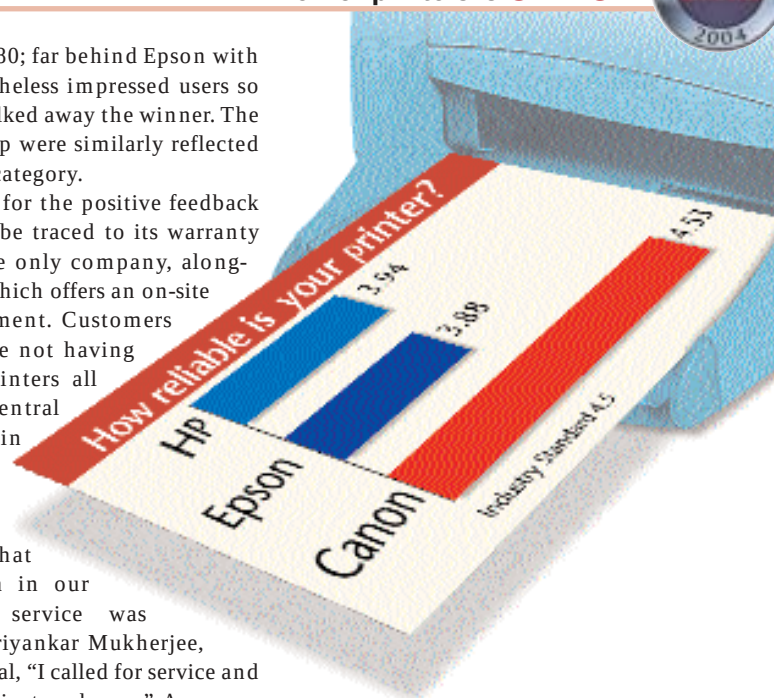
The sheer number of HP service centre is legion. Theoretically, their reach should address even the most remote Indian. Unfortunately, given the size and the diversity of the Indian market, it is not uncommon to run across cases like that of Suvidha Agarwal who says, "HP offers good reliable products, but it should open service centres in places like Kashipur in Uttaranchal." Suvidha further states that

Winner for printers is **CANON**



tant third with 80; far behind Epson with 187, but nevertheless impressed users so much that it walked away the winner. The results and setup were similarly reflected in the scanner category.

One reason for the positive feedback for Canon can be traced to its warranty service. It is the only company, alongside Lexmark, which offers an on-site printer replacement. Customers really appreciate not having to lug their printers all the way to a central service station in case something goes wrong; an appreciation that shines through in our survey. "The service was superb," says Priyanka Mukherjee, an IT professional, "I called for service and they came within two hours." Ameya, a student changed brands and is happy



lowering their prices, as an HP user, Vidhyadhis Desai, a hardware technician from Mumbai, put it, "Great printers! Only the prices for cartridges should be lowered." The cost of cartridges sees consumers go in for refilling, something that Kreisler Drego advises against: "HP print-

Great company, great product

Siddharth Shah, on his Canon printer
Valsad, Gujarat

she has to go to local vendors to get her problems solved.

While HP certainly commands a huge market share of printers and scanners, it loses out to Canon in both these segments on the basis of both product reliability and service. Printers got a whopping 1006 votes in our survey, and HP bit off 638 of that number. Canon came in a dis-

with his decision, "I used Epson prior to Canon, and was disappointed! No service at all." Another satisfied customer, Sethukumar S, a government employee, said that he "never faced any problem. The Canon printer is doing well."

A common grouse of consumers was the high cost associated with new cartridges, many a respondent suggested

Respondents owned **Epson printers** for the longest time and required the least amount of servicing in a **two-year** period